Artist Statement

2026 - Sienna Broglie

My work showcases the systems that produce our world. I first came to systems thinking as a way to process contradiction. A product of the Information Age, I have been shaped by the availability of multiple, opposing perspectives on nearly every topic. In this context, value judgments seem unstable, subject to bias. Rather than judging instances in isolation, it feels more honest to investigate their systems of production.

For several years I struggled to represent systems in my artwork. Seeing Bridget Riley's abstract depiction of nature and landscape through systems of form helped me imagine another approach: dividing the canvas into a grid.

The grid is visual mathematics, a way to paint systems. In my work, color is a variable manipulated through four stages: selection, combination, permutation, and repetition. I choose pigments, mix colors, randomize their order across a small grid, then repeat that grid across a larger one using random symmetrical transformations. The process generates one of many possible configurations from a finite set.

A game of discovery, I create dense fields of gluttonous color through many small squares. The color of each square and its neighbor is determined in collaboration with the roll of a die. Like genetic algorithms or the system of natural selection, the algorithm I use to paint is defined by random chance. Each painting explores how chance and circumstance interact to produce different outcomes, reflecting the diversity of life on Earth and among people in society as products of the environment, instances of systems.